of pitching in to support other operations directed at the US and its allies. Some members left to fight in Afghanistan while others distanced themselves from the group as a result of the leadership's willingness to submit to state oversight. But Lashkar remained relatively cohesive, and desertions and splintering were minimal compared to other outfits in Pakistan. Some of those who left were later welcomed back into the Lashkar-fold and others maintained connections to, as well as influence on, members in the organization. This later contributed to tensions within the group and facilitated the integration of Lashkar members with other outfits.

President Musharraf's decision to make a concerted effort to reduce militant activities in Indian-administered Kashmir had significant consequences for Lashkar. After Pakistan initiated the composite dialogue with India in 2004 it took limited steps to curtail militancy, sidelining some outfits. Lashkar sent smaller numbers of militants across the LoC, calibrating its activities in line with state directives. This enabled it to remain active in Indian-administered Kashmir, but less so than in the past. Pressure mounted on the group to slow its activities further after 2005 as the Musharraf regime sought to show results in the wake of the 7/7 London attacks. As a negotiated solution began to appear possible, Pakistan strengthened its efforts to scale back the Kashmir jihad and by 2006 even Indian officials admitted they were having an impact. The environment in Indian-administered Kashmir had also become less conducive to militancy by this time, which factored into the reduction in violence there. The leadership's decision to adhere to state directives weakened its internal credibility among pockets within the organization, at a time when overall control was attenuating as a result of the group' inability to maintain a high level of activity in Indian-administered Kashmir. Some Lashkar militants were willing to lay low, to edge toward non-violent activism in JuD or to return to their lives outside of the group. Others made their way to the Tribal Areas in order to join the insurgency in Afghanistan. Lashkar was a pan-Islamist outfit and so liberating Indian-administered Kashmir was never intended to be the apotheosis of its jihad. But senior leaders, as well as many of its rank-and-file, continued to view this as the most important front. Lashkar was closer to it and to the population, the group had built its reputation there and the proportion of 'occupiers' to 'occupied' remained high. Yet even if members were obligated to fight there, doing so had